

PROMPT PARTY

AI IMPROV

Scene-state engine, yes-and enforcement, audience twists, and recovery comedy

Packet	04
Status	Claude Code build-ready specification
Date	July 27, 2026

Build principle: reliability first, audience agency second, chaos only through controlled game objects.

Source Basis

This packet combines three supplied foundations:

- The shared Prompt Party game-engine contract developed in the conversation.
- The supplied Entertainment System Specification covering all five games, including comedy rules, power-ups, chaos events, pacing, failure recovery, and clip moments.
- The uploaded visual-show HTML prototype, which already separates Overview, Lobby, Shared System, Broadcast, Audience, Producer, and individual game views.

Where a source mechanic cannot be executed reliably in version one, this packet preserves its intent and assigns a controlled implementation or explicit fallback rather than silently deleting it.

1. Game Identity

Audience-directed short-form improv where AI players must accept established reality, add to it, and recover when a twist or broken rule makes the scene harder. The engine maintains a compact scene-state ledger so each player understands what is true inside the fiction.

2. Version-One Cast

Seat	Count	Required capability	Purpose
Player	3-4	text_generation	Perform one character and react to prior offers
Host/Emcee	1 AI or human	text_generation or producer	Introduce, enforce rules, end scene
Audience	room	browser session	Submit location, object, relationship, emotion, twist

3. Round Outputs

- Locked scene setup
- Character assignments
- Ordered dialogue turns
- Scene-state updates
- Rule violations and repairs
- Best Moment / Best Recovery votes
- Scene recap and replay

4. Shared Phase Mapping

Shared phase	Game meaning
LOBBY	Cast, room, provider health, game selection
SUBMISSION_OPEN	Audience submits approved input types
SUBMISSION_REVIEW	Automated screening and producer review
PROMPT_LOCKED	Final challenge becomes immutable for the round
ROUND_INTRO	Broadcast framing and contestant assignment
CONTESTANT_PLANNING	Short structured plans or opening positions
CREATION_ACTIVE	Generation, performance, testimony, or scene play
PRE_REVEAL_COMMENTARY	Commentators cover waiting or deliberate
REVEAL	Generated work or completed performance is shown
FINAL_JUDGING	Grounded critique and structured scores
AUDIENCE_VOTING	Audience vote opens and closes
SCORING / WINNER / POST-ROUND	Calculate, announce, banter, persist, reset

5. Scene State

```
{
  "scene_id": "scene_01J...",
  "location": "haunted library",
  "genre": "workplace comedy",
  "characters": [
    {
      "participant_id": "p1",
      "name": "Mara",
      "role": "exhausted librarian",
      "emotion": "calm panic"
    }
  ],
  "established_facts": [
```

```

"The stapler is the librarian",
"A book prevents it from awakening"
],
"active_objects": [
  "haunted stapler"
],
"relationships": [
  "Mara owes the laminator money"
],
"unresolved_threads": [
  "Who married the stapler?"
],
"active_modifier": null,
"turn_index": 4
}

```

STATE RULE: Dialogue may create new fictional facts, but the controller extracts and records them. Later players receive the compact ledger plus recent lines. No player may erase an established fact merely because it is inconvenient.

6. Turn Contract

You are {{character_name}} in an AI improv scene.

Scene state: {{compact_scene_state}}

Recent dialogue: {{last_three_lines}}

Active twist: {{modifier_or_none}}

Respond in character in 1-3 sentences. Accept the previous offer, add one playable detail, and reference at least one established fact or prior line.

Do not narrate an escape from the scene. Return JSON with spoken_line, accepted_offer, new_offer, referenced_fact_ids, proposed_state_updates.

```

{
  "spoken_line": "Then I will marry the stapler and inherit the overdue fines.",
  "accepted_offer": "The stapler is awake and controls the library.",
  "new_offer": "Marriage transfers the library debt.",
  "referenced_fact_ids": [
    "fact_stapler_librarian"
  ],
  "proposed_state_updates": [
    {
      "type": "relationship",
      "value": "Player is engaged to the stapler"
    }
  ]
}

```

7. Yes-And Validation

Check	Pass condition	Repair
Acceptance	Acknowledges prior offer or established reality	Host bell and one constrained revision
Addition	Introduces one playable detail	Request a concrete offer
Reference	Uses prior line/fact	Allow one revision
No escape	Does not wake up, end world, or narrate away conflict	Make attempted escape canon and continue
Twist timing	Audience twist appears within two player lines	Apply to next eligible line
Character	Maintains assigned role unless modifier changes it	Host corrects identity

Automated validation recommends a rule break, but the Host or producer controls the bell. The source specification explicitly keeps the bell and scene-ending decision manual.

8. Host Contract

- Recap only established scene facts.
- Call out denial or broken character without humiliating the participant.
- Apply one repair instruction at a time.
- Decide when the scene has a satisfying button or must be ended for pacing.
- During wait states, invite off-stage players to offer short unsolicited advice without changing scene reality.

9. Voting and Optional Winner

Vote	Purpose
Best Moment	Most entertaining line or beat
Best Recovery	Strongest justification after sabotage or rule break
MVP optional	Player who best accepted and advanced offers

The default mode does not require a single winner. For a tournament mode, the Host recommendation is advisory and the audience MVP vote decides.

Controlled Power-Ups and Chaos Events

ID	Display name	Valid phase	Effect	Fallback
freeze_replace	Freeze & Replace	CREATION_ACTIVE	Swap one character assignment at next turn boundary	Reject if scene ending
emotion_injection	Emotion Injection	CREATION_ACTIVE	Change target character emotion for two turns	Keep character identity
time_jump	Time Jump	CREATION_ACTIVE	Advance or rewind scene time by approved interval	Record new time anchor
object_endowment	Object Endowment	CREATION_ACTIVE	Adds one approved invisible object as real scene fact	Add to state ledger
scene_hijack	Scene Hijack	CREATION_ACTIVE	Bring off-stage player in as new character	Require available seat
genre_shift	Genre Shift	CREATION_ACTIVE	Change genre for next two turns	State facts remain true
one_word	One Word	CREATION_ACTIVE	Limit each line to one word for configured duration	Host may end early

Every modifier is a server-defined object. Audience choices select approved values; they do not inject raw instructions into model prompts.

Failure Recovery

Failure	Controller action	Public handling	Scoring rule
Non-sequitur	Host bell and justification turn	Line becomes intentional if successfully justified	Eligible for Best Recovery
Denial	One constrained revision	Host calls the denial	Repeated denial may skip turn
State extraction failure	Keep spoken line, producer confirms updates	Scene continues	No invented ledger update
Player timeout	Skip, replace, or host narrates absence	Character freezes dramatically	No automatic scene end

Required Acceptance Tests

1. Every turn receives compact state plus recent dialogue.
2. A proposed state update is not official until controller validation.
3. Established facts cannot disappear silently.
4. Audience twist is applied within two eligible turns.
5. Only the Host/producer rings the rule-break bell and ends the scene.
6. Freeze & Replace updates character assignment at a turn boundary.
7. Genre shifts do not erase scene facts.
8. Best Moment and Best Recovery votes close deterministically.
9. Timeout recovery does not fabricate a line.
10. Five scenes complete without facts leaking between scenes.

Version-One Boundaries

- Three to four players.
- Eight to twelve exchanges per scene.
- One active power-up at a time.
- No long-form Harold in v1.
- No unrestricted audience free-text reaches players without approval.